

Activities: Chat



The Chat activity module enables participants to have text-based, real-time synchronous discussions. The Chat may be a one-time activity or it may be repeated at the same time each day or each week. Chat sessions are saved and can be made available for everyone to view or restricted so that users only have the ability to view chat session logs.

Chats are especially useful when students are not able to meet face-to-face. Some examples of how an Instructor may use Chats are:

1. Regular meetings with online students to enable their sharing of experiences with others.
2. A student temporarily unable to attend class in person or synchronously online; they can chat with their instructor to catch up with work.
3. Students out on work terms getting together to discuss their experiences with each other and their instructor.
4. Sessions to help students prepare for tests where the instructor, or other students, could pose sample questions.

Contents

- Add a Chat
- Edit Chat Settings
- Using a Chat
- Chat Reports
- Delete a Chat
- Notes

To Add a Chat Room:

Turn editing on

1. Turn editing on by clicking the 'Turn editing on' button on the top right of your screen.
2. Click the 'Add an activity or resource' button on the bottom right of the section (location) where you want to add the new file.
3. A pop-up window will appear on your screen. Scroll down. Under 'Activities,' select the 'Chat' option. Click 'Add' at the bottom of the window.

+ Add an activity or resource



Edit Settings:

▼ General

1

2

Name of this chat room*

Description

Paragraph ▼

B

I

☰

☰

🔗

🔗

🔗

🖼️

📺

📄

Path: p

Display description on course page ☐

?

1. Fill in the **Chat name**. Ensure the name of the Chat identifies the purpose of the Chat activity. For example, 'Chat for studying for Mid-term' or 'Chat for asking Instructor Questions.'
2. In the **Description** field you may give the student more details on the Chat activity. You may display the Description on the course page if you select the **Display description on the course page** box. Only do this if it is imperative to give the students further directions before they enter the Chat. Having descriptions on the course page 'clutters' the home page, making navigation through your course more difficult for the student.

▼ Chat sessions

3 Next chat time 10 ▾ July ▾ 2016 ▾ 10 ▾ 15 ▾ 

4 Repeat/publish session times Don't publish any chat times ▾

5 Save past sessions Never delete messages ▾

6 Everyone can view past sessions No ▾



3. **Next Chat time** is when this virtual chat room will be open for use. It is important to have the correct day, year and time that you would like to use this feature.
4. **Repeat/publish session times** can be used for daily or weekly chats. The time you select does not enable/disable the chat room. It only tells students when to expect activity.
To disable a chat room, see Common module settings>Visible. Change form Show to Hide.

Common module settings * Hide advanced

Group mode  No groups ▾

Grouping*  None ▾

Visible  Show ▾ 

ID number 

5. If you want the **Save past sessions**, you can use the drop-down menu to set how long chat messages persist. The minimum is 2 days; the maximum is forever.
6. **Everyone can view past sessions:** If set to no, then only instructors and moderators can view the chat logs.

Common module settings * Hide advanced

7 Group mode  No groups ▾

Grouping*  None ▾

8 Visible  Show ▾

9 ID number 

7. **Group Mode and Grouping:** Group mode and Grouping only works if you have already set up Groups/Groupings for the course. If you have Groups in your course, the following options are available.
No Groups means everyone is in the same community.
Separate Groups means students can only chat with their own group
Visible Groups means students can read other groups, but only post in their own
8. **Visible:** Shows or hides the chat room on the course page. This is a means to disable a Chat.

Hidden: Instructors will see the Chat (light grey to show it is hidden), but students will not be able to see the activity.

Show: Visible to all.

9. **ID number** is how the chat will appear in the grade book, should you choose to grade the chat activity.

10. Click **Save** to finish setting up the chat.

Using a Chat

Entering the chat

When you enter the Chat, the **Chat Name** and **Directions** will appear on the top of the window. You may enter the Chat by clicking on the **Click here to enter the chat now** or **Use more accessible interface**. The appearance of the Chat differs for the accessible interface, having a more appealing, easier to follow application. (See screen shots below.)

What else you see when entering a Chat depends upon your settings. If you have groups in your course, you will have a drop down box to delineate who you are chatting with; the entire class or specific groups and whether they can view each other's chats.

Questions about the Mid-term Return to course ↗

Please enter your questions and suggestions about the mid-term. Weigh in on what you think should be on the mid-term. Maybe I will give you a few emoticon hints if I agree with your suggestions.

1

Separate groups All participants ▼

[Click here to enter the chat now](#)

[Use more accessible interface](#)

2 Chat session will start in: 6 days 3 hours

[Click here to enter the chat now](#)

[Use more accessible interface](#)

[View past chat sessions](#)

What you will see upon entry into the Chat depends upon what you chose for settings.
 Example #1 Open Chat, Students are unable to see past Chats.
 Example #2 Specified start for a Chat. Students are able to see past chats.

Click here to enter the Chat: The Chat window appears as a pop-up.

Module #6: Assessments: Questions about the Mid-term: All participants ...

https://moodle-dev.norquest.ca/mod/chat/gui_ajax/index.php?id=426

15:32 Joan Wall Joan Wall has just entered this chat

15:33 Joan Wall
Hi, I am wondering how everyone is doing. Do you feel prepared for the Mid-Term next week? Do you have any questions about the course content or the structure of the upcoming mid-term?

Write here.... **Send** Themes »

Use a simpler interface: The simpler interface provides a simpler looking chat room look with fewer frames.

Module #6: Assessments
Questions about the Mid-term
Participants

 Joan Wall

Send message

Type here and see the message below.

Submit **Refresh** ☐ Show only new

Messages

From	Message	Time
Joan	This is the simpler interface	15:55

Two choices on Themes (or how the chats appear)

Send
Themes »

In normal view, the screen is in two parts with the participants on the right, the messages on the left and a box at the bottom into which users type their message and press "**Send**" to make their contribution. Under **Theme** there are two viewing options: Bubbles and Compact. (See below.)

Bubbles theme: Text appears in speech bubbles.

This Chat provides you an opportunity to ask any last minute questions about the course or course content. I want you all to do well in the class, so I hope you will have time in the next 2 days to go over the Modules #1-#4.

17:04 tststu two_JW tststu two_JW has just entered this chat

I'm very worried about the midterm. I have missed a few classes at the beginning of the term. What do you think is the most important material to cover in

Compact theme: Information presented in a more linear fashion.

17:10 Joan Wall
Don't worry

17:10 tststu two_JW tststu two_JW has just entered this chat

17:10 tststu two_JW
Be happy

Joan Wall

tststu two_JW
Talk Beep

Beep and Talk

17:20 Joan Wall
Hi

17:20 tststu two_JW tststu two_JW has just entered this chat

17:20 tststu two_JW
Hi

17:21 Joan Wall
You beeped tststu two_JW

17:22 Joan Wall
I am glad you came to this session. I wanted to let you know what you missed last class.

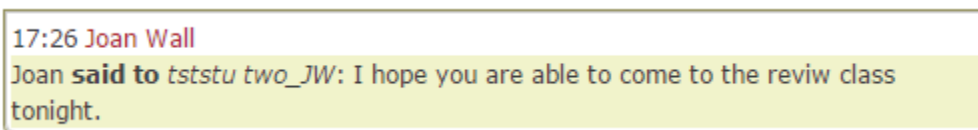
Joan Wall

tststu two_JW
Talk Beep

↑ ↑

You can send a sound to other people by selecting the **Beep** link next to their name. A useful shortcut to beep all the people in the chat at once is to type "**beep all**".

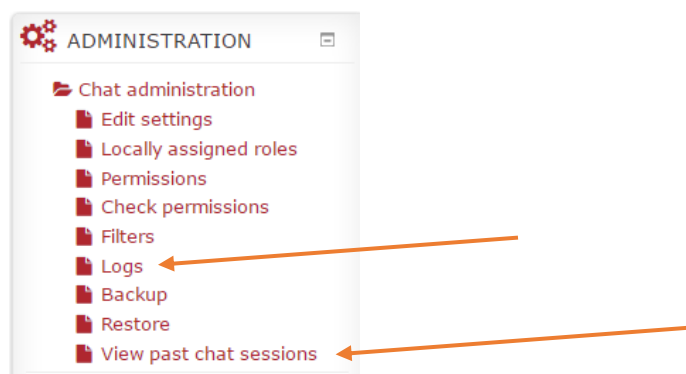
If you click the '**Talk**' link by a person's name, it will then add their name in the chat box to show your message is directed at that particular person.



Chat Reports

When you click on the Chat, the **Administration Block** pertains to the Chat.

You may **View past chat sessions**. This will bring up a listing of each chat session under the current chat topic. The listings include the time the chat started and ended, which users participated, and how many messages each user sent. Individual sessions may be deleted by clicking the '**Delete**' link.



Logs

You may also view **Logs**. This will show you all the activity in the **Chat**. You may select one student to see their participation in the Chat. If you are interested in viewing one student, you may also select **Create** on the drop down menu for **All actions** to view when the student posted to the Chat versus when they viewed the Chat.

Module #6: Assessments

Module #6: Assessments ▾ All groups ▾ tststu two_JW ▾ All days ▾

Questions about the Mid-term ▾ Create ▾ Educational level ▾ Standard log ▾ [Get these logs](#)

Time	User full name	Affected user	Event context	Component	Event name	Description	Origin	IP address
10 Jul, 16:06	tststu two_JW	tststu two_JW	Chat: Questions about the Mid-term	Chat	Message sent	The user with id '1047' has sent a message in the chat with course module id '133451'.	web	50.65.226.49
10 Jul, 15:50	tststu two_JW	tststu two_JW	Chat: Questions about the Mid-term	Chat	Message sent	The user with id '1047' has sent a message in the chat with course module id '133451'.	web	50.65.226.49

Download table data as [Comma separated values text file](#) [Download](#)

Viewing Past Chats

Questions about the Mid-term

[Return to course](#)

Separate groups [All participants](#)

Sunday, 10 July 2016, 4:03 PM --> Sunday, 10 July 2016, 4:11 PM

- 16:03: Joan Wall has left this chat
- 16:03: Joan Wall has just entered this chat
- 16:03 Joan: Hi, I am wondering how everyone is doing. Do you feel prepared for the Mid-Term next week? Do you have any questions about the course content or the structure of the upcoming mid-term?
- 16:05: tststu two_JW has just entered this chat
- 16:06 tststu: Are we able to use scrap paper to plan for our essay questions when writing the mid-term?
- 16:08: tststu two_JW has left this chat
- 16:09 Joan: Hi Tststu, Yes you may use scrap paper but it will be handed out at the beginning of the mid-term. Do not bring paper to the mid-term. Please print your name on top of the scrap paper and return it to me at the end of the mid-term. I sometimes like looking at a students's planning.

Delete a Chat

1. Go to the course home page.
2. Click on the **Turn editing on** button.
3. Click **Edit** next to the Label resource.
4. Click **Delete**.

Notes:

When you enter a Chat, you do not see the messages prior to your arrival. Stress to the students that, if they want to see all the chats, they should arrive in the Chat at the appropriate time, especially if you as the instructor are not allowing the students to view past Chat sessions.

For additional information, see [Using Chats Moodle Docs](#) or contact Moodle Help.